mythmaker. Even nuclear physicists have found themselves obeying the commands of Shiite ayatollahs and communist apparatchiks.

The alignment problem turns out to be, at heart, a problem of mythology. Nazi administrators could have been committed deontologists or utilitarians, but they would still have murdered millions as long as they understood the world in terms of a racist mythology. If you start with the mythological belief that Jews are demonic monsters bent on destroying humanity, then both deontologists and utilitarians can find many logical arguments why the Jews should be killed.

An analogous problem might well afflict computers. Of course, they cannot 'believe' in any mythology, because they are non-conscious entities that don't believe in anything. As long as they lack subjectivity, how can they hold intersubjective beliefs? However, one of the most important things to realise about computers is that when a lot of computers communicate with one another, they can create inter-computer realities, analogous to the intersubjective realities produced by networks of humans. These inter-computer realities may eventually become as powerful – and as dangerous – as human-made intersubjective myths.

This is a very complicated argument, but it is another of the central arguments of the book, so let's go over it carefully. First, let's try to understand what inter-computer realities are. As an initial example, consider a one-player computer game. In such a game, you can wander inside a virtual landscape that exists as information within one computer. If you see a rock, that rock is not made of atoms. It is made of bits inside a single computer. When several computers are linked to one another, they can create inter-computer realities. Several players using different computers can wander together inside a common virtual landscape. If they see a rock, that rock is made of bits in several computers.[45]

Just as intersubjective realities like money and gods can influence the physical reality outside people's minds, so inter-computer realities can influence reality outside the computers. In 2016 the game *Pokémon Go* took the world by storm and was downloaded hundreds of millions of times by the end of the year.[46] *Pokémon Go* is an augmented reality mobile game. Players can use their smartphones to locate, fight and capture virtual creatures called Pokémon, which seem to exist in the physical world. I once went with my nephew Matan on such a Pokémon hunt. Walking around his neighbourhood, I saw only houses, trees, rocks, cars, people, cats, dogs and